香港大学-复旦大学IMBA项目
HKU–Fudan IMBA Programme

THE UNIVERSITY OF HONG KONG / FUDAN UNIVERSITY
FACULTY OF BUSINESS AND ECONOMICS
MASTER OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION (INTERNATIONAL)

IMBA6067 BRANDING AND COMMUNICATIONS
COURSE OUTLINE

A) GENERAL INFORMATION

Instructor: Dr. Royce Yuen, JP, Adjunct Associate Professor, HKU
Email: royceyuen@yahoo.com | LinkedIn: www.linkedin.com/in/royceyuen | WeChat: drroyceyuen

Consultation times: Students are welcome to discuss any course-related issues directly with the instructor. Consultations are available before or after class, and appointments can be arranged by contacting either the teaching assistant or the instructor.

Prerequisites: This course welcomes students with a high interest in branding and marketing, with an open and inquiring mind, and who are eager to collaborate and actively contribute to group discussions.

About the Instructor

Dr. Royce Yuen brings over 30 years of brand-building and business management experience across China, Hong Kong, and international markets. He is currently the CEO of MaLogic, a professional consulting firm specializing in business solutions that integrate research insights, branding strategies, and big data analytics.

Previously, Dr. Yuen served as Chairman of Ogilvy South China and Hong Kong, where he led the agency to top rankings by Marketing Magazine and Campaign Brief Asia. From 2005 to 2010, he was Chairman of the HK4As, the trade association for Hong Kong's advertising industry, acting as a spokesperson for the creative sector.

Dr. Yuen is also deeply committed to public service. He has advised numerous non-profit organizations and held council positions with the Hong Kong Trade Development Council (2009–2015) and the Hong Kong Academy for Performing Arts (2010–2016). He served as Vice-Chairman of PLAN International (HK) from 2009 to 2019 and currently advises Our Hong Kong Foundation.

With over two decades of experience teaching branding and marketing at the postgraduate level, Dr. Yuen is an Adjunct Associate Professor at the School of Business, where he has taught for ten

years in both Hong Kong and Shanghai (Fudan University). He is a frequent speaker at major conferences and has hosted numerous TV and radio programs to promote management as a liberal art.

Dr. Yuen's achievements have been widely recognized. He was conferred an Honorary Fellowship by HK PolyU in 2015, named Scholar Marketer of the Year and Honorary Fellow by the Hong Kong Marketing Institute (HKMI) in 2019, and appointed Justice of the Peace by the HKSAR in 2010. He was inducted into the HKMI Hall of Fame in 2022 and was honored as one of Campaign Asia's inaugural "50 over Fifty" awardees in 2025. Dr. Yuen holds a Master of Arts in Marketing from Macquarie University and a Doctor of Business Administration from HK PolyU.

B) COURSE DESCRIPTION

This course is designed to bridge the gap between academic theory and real-world business practice in the field of branding. Branding is not only a subject of extensive academic research but also a critical component of day-to-day management. In today's uncertain market environment, a strong and enduring brand is widely recognized as an organization's most valuable asset. Beyond attracting customers, a powerful brand draws talent, collaborators, and investors—making a solid understanding of branding principles essential for all senior managers, regardless of discipline.

Throughout the course, branding will be examined from a holistic perspective. Foundational theories from leading scholars such as Kotler, Aaker, and Levitt will be explored, complemented by the instructor's extensive practical experience. Case studies from both global and Asian contexts will provide students with relevant, actionable insights for effective brand management in their own organizations.

The curriculum integrates critical theories with current marketing topics, including but not limited to:

- Branding in the digital age
- The emergence of disruptive brands
- Brand management during economic turmoil
- CSR and ESG
- Big data and big branding
- The art and science of branding
- Celebrity and KOL marketing
- Post COVID-19 branding insights

The course consists of eight sessions delivered over four full days (two sessions per day), each focusing on a key aspect of branding. The primary objective is to equip senior executives in China with an international perspective and the skills to practice branding and marketing at the highest global standards.

Textbook: ***Decoding Branding – A Complete Guide to Building and Revamping Brands in the Age of Disruption*** **by Royce Yuen; 2021; Routledge**

A complete set of lecture handouts in PowerPoint format will be uploaded to Moodle. For ease of communication, some presentation slides may contain only key bullet points rather than the full details of each concept. Therefore, it is highly recommended that students purchase the designated textbook, which provides comprehensive explanations of the branding concepts discussed in class.

The textbook will be a valuable resource, especially for the mid-term business case review, during which students may refer to the book to help solve the assigned business problem. In addition, the textbook features interviews with renowned brand-builders and includes relevant business case studies that complement the course content.

Students are encouraged to consider purchasing an e-copy of the textbook if printed copies are unavailable at the bookstore, so they can begin pre-reading before the course commences.

Teaching assistant: Mr. Chaoyi Ding will be supporting this course as teaching assistant.
(Email: jasoncyding@163.com)

C) COURSE OBJECTIVES

This course is designed to equip senior managers with a comprehensive understanding of branding and the skills necessary to build strong, enduring brands that drive superior business performance. Emphasizing the challenges and opportunities presented by technological innovation and digitalization, the course aims to empower senior executives in China with a global perspective and the ability to apply branding and marketing practices at the highest international standards.

D) INTENDED COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES (ILOs):

Upon successful completion of this course, students will be able to:

ILO1	Gain a comprehensive understanding of brand management, supported by real-world case studies and examples.
ILO2	Appreciate the concept of branding and its strategic value to organizations, even for those from non-marketing backgrounds.
ILO3	Enhance their marketing acumen and apply advanced branding knowledge to their professional roles, particularly for those working in marketing-related fields.

ILO4	Enrich their skills and expertise through active participation in group projects and class discussions, fostering cross-disciplinary learning and collaboration.

E) ALIGNMENT OF PROGRAM AND COURSE ILOs

Program ILOs	Course ILOs
1. Acquisition and internalization of knowledge and skills in key functional areas	**ILO1, ILO2, ILO3,**
2. Application of business knowledge to solve business problems	**ILO2, ILO3, IL04**
3. Develop managerial leadership and inculcate professional ethics and competency in business	**ILO1, ILO4**
4. Developing global outlook	**ILO1, ILO4**
5. Mastering communication skills	**IL02, IL03, ILO4**

F) ASSESSMENT AND MAPPING TO INTENDED LEARNING OBJECTIVES:

There is no examination for this course. Instead, assessment is based on active participation in team-based activities, a mid-term business case review, and a final group project. These components are designed to reinforce key learning objectives and provide practical experience in brand management.

Assessment Components:

- **Class Exercises:**
  Students will be divided into teams (approximately six to seven members per team) to engage in a series of class exercises. These activities are designed to encourage the exchange of ideas and collaborative problem-solving, focusing on real business challenges from various industries.

- **Mid-term Business Case Review:**
  Teams will analyze and present solutions to a business case, applying branding concepts and drawing on textbook resources.

- **Final Group Project:**
  The capstone of the course is a group project, culminating in presentations during the final session. Each team will develop a new startup idea and build its brand (of any business nature), applying the theories and strategies learned throughout the course. Presentations will be allotted 15 minutes per group (subject to adjustment based on class size), with the order determined by random draw. The instructor will provide immediate feedback to help refine and sharpen the proposals.

In addition to instructor evaluation, students will participate in peer assessment, with student judging accounting for 20% of the final grade.

Group Project Evaluation Criteria:

1. **Market Analysis (20%)**: Assessment of market trends and opportunities identified.
2. **Originality (10%)**: Evaluation of the novelty and appeal of the idea to the target market.
3. **Viability (10%)**: Practicality and feasibility of the business concept.
4. **Consumer Insights (10%)**: Depth of consumer understanding underpinning the business model.
5. **Branding Insights (20%)**: Integration of branding principles from course material.
6. **Profit Potential (10%)**: Likelihood of achieving profitability.
7. **Marketing & Promotion Ideas (10%)**: Effectiveness of proposed marketing and promotional strategies.
8. **Scalability (10%)**: Potential for business expansion and growth.

Learning Objectives Mapping:

- Develop a comprehensive understanding of brand management through practical application.
- Foster appreciation for branding's value across disciplines, including for students from non-marketing backgrounds.
- Advance marketing thinking and apply branding knowledge to real-world scenarios.
- Enhance teamwork, communication, and cross-disciplinary collaboration through group projects and peer evaluation.

This assessment structure ensures that students not only grasp theoretical concepts but also gain hands-on experience in applying branding and communication strategies to real business challenges.

Assessment Method	Weighting (%)	Intended Learning Objectives
1. Attendance & participation	10 %	ILO1, ILO2, ILO3, IL04
2. Mid-term business case review	20%	ILO2, ILO3, IL04
2. Final Group Project Presentation - assessment by instructor (50%) - assessment by students (20%)	70 %	ILO1, ILO2, ILO3
	Total: 100%	

G) STANDARD FOR ASSESSMENT

A+, A, A-	**(Excellent to Very Good):** Demonstrates outstanding comprehension of key concepts and excels in applying these concepts with viable and innovative ideas in real business contexts.
B+, B, B-	**(Very Good to Good):** Shows strong understanding of key concepts and is able to apply them effectively with sound rationale in practical situations.
C+, C, C-	**(Good to Fair):** Displays a satisfactory grasp of key concepts, with some ability to apply them.
D+ D	**(Fair):** Demonstrates a basic understanding of key concepts, with limited application.
F	**(Fail):** Fails to demonstrate a basic understanding of key concepts.

H) ASSESSMENT RUBRICS FOR EACH ASSESSMENT

1. Class Exercises

Criteria	**A+, A, A- (Excellent)**	**B+, B, B- (Good)**	**C+, C, C- (Satisfactory)**	**D+, D (Marginal)**	**F (Fail)**
Comprehension of Concepts	Demonstrates thorough understanding of key branding concepts; insightful contributions	Good understanding; contributions show clear grasp of concepts	Basic understanding; some relevant contributions	Limited understanding; minimal input	Lacks understanding
Application to Practice	Applies concepts creatively and effectively to real business scenarios	Applies concepts with sound rationale	Applies concepts in a basic manner	Struggles to apply concepts	No application shown
Teamwork & Participation	Actively engages and collaborates; leads discussions	Participates well; supports team	Participates occasionally	Rarely participates	No participation
Communication	Communicates ideas clearly/persuasively	Communicates ideas clearly	Communication is adequate	Communication is unclear	Fails to communicate ideas

2. Mid-term Business Case Review

Criteria	A+, A, A- (Excellent)	B+, B, B- (Good)	C+, C, C- (Satisfactory)	D+, D (Marginal)	F (Fail)
Analysis & Insight	Provides deep, insightful analysis; identifies key issues and opportunities	Good analysis; identifies most key issues	Basic analysis; identifies some issues	Limited analysis; misses key issues	No meaningful analysis
Application of Concepts	Integrates course concepts expertly; solutions are innovative and viable	Applies concepts well; solutions are practical	Applies some concepts; solutions are basic	Struggles to apply concepts; weak solutions	No application or solutions
Use of Evidence	Supports arguments with strong evidence and examples	Supports arguments with relevant evidence	Some evidence used; may lack relevance	Little evidence provided	No evidence used
Presentation & Structure	Exceptionally clear, logical, and well-organized	Clear and organized	Adequate structure	Lacks clarity and organization	Disorganized or unclear

3. Final Group Project

Criteria	A+, A, A- (Excellent)	B+, B, B- (Good)	C+, C, C- (Satisfactory)	D+, D (Marginal)	F (Fail)
Market Analysis (20%)	Thorough, insightful analysis of trends and opportunities; highly relevant	Good analysis; relevant opportunities identified	Basic analysis; some relevance	Limited or unclear analysis	No analysis provided
Originality (10%)	Highly original, creative, and attractive idea	Good originality; idea is appealing	Some originality; idea is somewhat appealing	Lacks originality; idea is weak	No originality

Criteria	A+, A, A- (Excellent)	B+, B, B- (Good)	C+, C, C- (Satisfactory)	D+, D (Marginal)	F (Fail)
Viability (10%)	Idea is highly practical and feasible	Idea is practical and feasible	Idea is somewhat feasible	Idea is not practical or feasible	Not viable
Consumer Insights (10%)	Deep, actionable consumer insights underpin the idea	Good consumer insights; relevant to idea	Some consumer insights; limited relevance	Minimal or unclear insights	No consumer insights
Branding Insights (20%)	Excellent integration of branding principles; demonstrates mastery	Good integration of branding principles	Some integration of branding principles	Limited or incorrect application	No branding principles applied
Profit Potential (10%)	Strong, well-supported profit potential	Good profit potential; rationale provided	Some profit potential; limited rationale	Weak or unsupported profit potential	No profit potential
Marketing & Promotion (10%)	Highly effective, creative marketing strategies	Good marketing strategies; practical	Basic marketing strategies	Weak or impractical strategies	No marketing strategies
Scalability (10%)	Clear, compelling plan for scaling the business	Good plan for scalability	Some consideration of scalability	Limited or unclear scalability plan	No scalability plan
Presentation (Overall)	Exceptionally clear, engaging, and professional	Clear and professional	Adequate presentation	Unclear or unprofessional presentation	Disorganized or incomplete
Teamwork & Collaboration	Excellent collaboration; all members contribute	Good collaboration; most members contribute	Adequate collaboration; uneven contribution	Limited collaboration; few contribute	No collaboration

I) TEACHING AND LEARNING ACTIVITIES / COURSE SCHEDULE

Class schedule: July 24 to 27, 2025

Session One and Two	Understanding Brands from Multiple Dimensions: Part I : Critical Conventional Concepts – Brand equity – Brand positioning – Brand personality – Brand identity – Brand life cycle – Brand valuation – Brand portfolio Understanding Brands from Multiple Dimensions: Part II : Current Challenges – Brand architecture – Non-commercial branding – country, charity organization, NGO, Politicians – CEO and corporate brand – You as a brand
Session Three and Four	Advanced Brand Management: Part I : Brand Portfolio, Competition and Rejuvenation – Branding and "new" marketing 4Ps – Branding and Porter's Competitive Forces – The Enhanced Nine Competitive Forces in the digital era – Brand extension, line extension, and brand proliferation – Aging brands and brand rejuvenation Advanced Brand Management: Part II : Branding in Digital and Dynamic Environment - Branding in the digital age – YouTube, Google, Facebook, etc. - Crisis management for brand - Brand strategies – offensive vs. defensive - Brand integrity and crisis management
Session Five and Six	Effective Brand Communications Part I : Customer Engagement – Branding and consumer insight – understanding the local culture, role play between parents & child, aging population, and affluent grey (changing demographics) – What customers really want in the 21st century – Brand ideal – building brands on ideal, not just ideas

	– Building brands by appealing to the five senses Part II : Customer Engagement - Communicating your bands – 360 Branding, celebrity endorsement, purchase cycle, customer journey and ownership - Internal branding - Brand ambassadors – CEO, staff, partners, clients, customers - Brand loyalty – Differential Marketing (DFM) - Leveraging database marketing and CRM in brand-building - Developing integrated marketing communication approach for maximum business result - Luxury brands vs. no frills
Session Seven	Branding in a New Era: Part I : Turmoil and Globalization - Managing brands during economic turmoil - Post COVID-19 implications and insights – Building and managing global brands – global vs. local – CSR and sustainability Part II : Rise of Disruptive Brands - Disruptive brands and the sharing economy - Characteristics of disruptive brands – Uber, Airbnb, WeWork Part III : Understanding the largest market in the world - China - Patriotic paradox – The rise of China and Chinese brands - The unique eco-system of China market - China's Five Year Plan and country priorities - Emerging middle class and the consumer trends in China - Single's Day, WeChat, KOL, and live streaming in China Part IV : Big Data and IoT - 4V of Big Data - Art and science of branding - Retail science and the future of brand development - The 10 Cs of sustainable branding
Session Eight	Group Project Presentations – Introduction by the instructor Presentation by students Judging by students and prize presentation to winning team - Feedback from the instructor and wrap up

J) MEANS/PROCESSES FOR STUDENT FEEDBACK ON COURSE

- **Instructor Feedback:**
  After the final group project presentations, each team will receive detailed verbal feedback from the instructor, drawing on professional experience to help students broaden their perspectives and identify ways to enhance their ideas further.

- **In-depth Analysis:**
  The instructor will also share professional perspectives and analysis during class exercises, offering insights into effective approaches for tackling business problems. This real-time feedback will help students understand practical applications of course concepts and enhance their problem-solving skills.

- **Model Answers:**
  Model answers for the mid-term business case review will be provided and discussed in class, enabling students to compare their recommendations with best-practice solutions and deepen their understanding of key concepts.

K) COURSE POLICY

The University Regulations on academic dishonesty will be strictly enforced. Please check the University Statement on plagiarism on https://tl.hku.hk/plagiarism/ .

Cheating or plagiarism of any kind would result in an automatic F grade for the course plus strict enforcement of all Faculty and/or University regulations regarding such behavior. Incident(s) of academic dishonesty will NOT be tolerated.

Academic dishonesty is a behavior in which a deliberately fraudulent misrepresentation is employed in an attempt to gain undeserved intellectual credit, either for oneself or for another. It includes, but is not necessarily limited to, the following types of cases:

a. Plagiarism - the representation of someone else's ideas as if they are one's own. Where the arguments, data, designs, etc., of someone else are being used in a paper, report, oral presentation, or similar academic project, this fact must be made explicitly clear by citing the appropriate references. The references must fully indicate the extent to which any parts of the project are not one's own work. Paraphrasing of someone else's ideas is still using someone else's ideas, and must be acknowledged.
b. Unauthorized Collaboration on Out-of-Class Projects - the representation of work as solely one's own when in fact it is the result of a joint effort.
c. Cheating on In-Class Exams - the covert gathering of information from other students, the use of unauthorized notes, unauthorized aids, etc.
d. Unauthorized Advance Access to an Exam - the representation of materials prepared at leisure, as a result of unauthorized advance access (however obtained), as if it were

prepared under the rigors of the exam setting. This misrepresentation is dishonest in itself even if there are not compounding factors, such as unauthorized uses of books or notes.

All assignments will be uploaded to Turnitin for originality checking and to identify potential plagiarism, if any.

Where a candidate for a degree or other award uses the work of another person or persons without due acknowledgement:

1. The relevant Board of Examiners may impose a penalty in relation to the seriousness of the offence.
2. The relevant Board of Examiners may report the candidate to the Senate, where there is *prima facie* evidence of an intention to deceive and where sanctions beyond those in (1) might be invoked.

L) RECOMMENDED READINGS

Advertising Works and How by Laurence Green; 2005; IPA

Brands and Branding by Rita Clifton and John Simmons; 2003; The Economist

Brand Child by Martin Lindstorm; 2003; Kogan Page

Brand Equity and Advertising by David A. Aaker; 1993; Lawrence Erlbaum Associates

Brand Immortality by Hamish Pringle and Peter Field; 2008; Kogan Page

Building Strong Brands by David A. Aaker; 1996; Free Press

Consumer Insight by Merlin Stone, Alison Bond and Bryan Foss; 2004; Kogan Page

DigiMarketing by Kent Wertime & Ian Fenwick; 2008; John Wiley & Son

Global Brand Integrity Management by Richard S. Post and Penelope N. Post; 2008; McGraw-Hill

Growing Up Digital by Don Tapscott; 1998; McGraw-Hill, Inc.

Integrated Marketing by Ian Linton and Kevin Morley; 1995; Butterworth-Heinemann Ltd.

Integrated Marketing by Richard N. Skinner; 1994; McGraw-Hill, Inc.

Integrated Marketing Communications by Don E. Schultz, Stanley I. Tannenbaum and Robert F. Lauterborn; 1993; NTC

Integrated Marketing Communications – Advertising and Promotion in a Digital World by Jerome M. Juska; 2018; Routledge

Managing Brand Equity by David A. Aaker; 1991; Free Press

Marketing 3.0: From Products to Customers to The Human Spirit by Philip Kotler, Hermawan Kartajaya and Iwan Setiawan; 2010; John Wiley & Son

Social Media Explained: Untangling the World's Most Misunderstood Business Trend by Mark Schaefer; 2014; Amazon Publishing

Strategic Brand Management by Jean-Noel Kapferer; 1992; Free Press

Strategic Integrated Marketing Communications by Larry Percy; 2018; Routledge

The Handbook of Brand Management by David Arnold; 1992; Century Business

The New Positioning by Jack Trout; 1996; McGraw-Hill

The Next Evolution of Marketing: Connecting Your Customers By Meaningful Marketing by Bob Gilbreath; 2010: McGraw Hill
What Customers Really Want by Scott Mckain; 2005; Nelson Business
Warp Speed Branding by Agnieszka M. Winkler; 1999; John Wiley & Son

Last Update: June 2025